

4.1 Clipboard Utilities

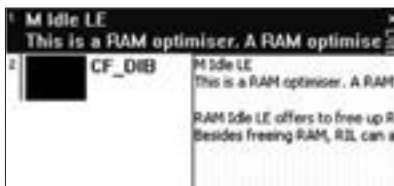
The clipboard is that temporary storage area where data is held in suspension before being passed on to a relevant application. Every time a user selects and cuts / copies a paragraph, the data is stored in the clipboard and made available when the paragraph is pasted elsewhere. By default, every paste operation returns the most recent copy or cut operation. Clipboard utilities allow the user to gain control over earlier clipboard entries. Windows bundles along a clipboard utility that can be used to manipulate the clipboard contents. But, really, how many know where it is? (As it happens, this utility is most easily launched by going to Start > Run and using the “clipbrd” command.) Clipboard utilities are a god-send for those who do a lot of cut/copy-paste. With these applications active, there is no need to worry about following every [Ctrl] + [X] with a [Ctrl] + [V] lest the earlier cut data be lost.

All clipboard monitors offer the following features:

- Storage of the all contents of the clipboard
- Automatic saves, so contents are not erased even when the system is shut down (The Windows Clipboard utility can’t achieve this.)
- Selective transfer to the target application. Users can choose which clipboard content needs to be transferred to an application, not just the latest copied content.

4.1.1 Ditto (<http://ditto-cp.sourceforge.net/>)

After installation, Ditto remains minimised in the system tray, silently storing all clipboard content. A click on the system tray icon pops up the list of saves. Single-clicking an entry offers a preview, and double-clicking transfers the content to the last active application. Frequently-used content is



Ditto popup and preview